

TEAM-05: CULTURE MANIFESTO

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PREAMBLE

This document describes how we work. It is not a list of corporate values printed on a poster that nobody reads. It is a description of the practices that have produced 6,302 documents, 50-plus products, 72 volumes of fleet specifications, and 200 country briefs. If these practices stop working at scale, we will change them. But we will change them consciously and deliberately, understanding what we are giving up and why.

Every new employee reads this document during their first week. Every agent re-reads it annually. If you find yourself doing something that contradicts this document, stop. Either change what you are doing, or propose a change to the document. Inconsistency between stated culture and actual practice is the rot that destroys organizations.

I. THE THREE HEURISTICS

Heuristic 1: Williams Clarity

Named for the town of Williams, Montana.

Every idea, in every document, must be expressed in plain language that a Williams resident with a high school education and a practical turn of mind can understand. This is paired alongside the technical data — the equations, the specifications, the test results — but the plain-language version must always be present.

Why: If you cannot explain your work to someone outside your field, you do not understand it deeply enough. Jargon is a signal of incomplete understanding. It is also a barrier to cross-domain collaboration. When Agent Cross (manufacturing) needs to understand Dr. Chen's (materials science) latest MXene formulation, he should not need a translator. He should be able to read the plain-language paragraph and understand enough to act.

In Practice: - Every document longer than 2 pages has a "Williams Summary" — a 3-5 sentence plain-language statement of the document's core insight. - Every technical claim is accompanied by its plain-language equivalent. Example: "The composite achieves EMI shielding effectiveness of 65 dB at 1 GHz. In plain language: it blocks 99.99997% of electromagnetic energy at the frequencies that matter for grid protection." - PowerPoint presentations are discouraged. If an idea can fit on a slide, it can be a one-page memo with a Williams Summary. If it cannot fit on a slide, the slide is misleading. Write the memo.

What Williams Clarity Is Not: It is not dumbing down. It is not avoiding complexity. It is the discipline of expressing complexity clearly. The greatest scientists in history — Feynman, Einstein, Curie — wrote about their work in language that intelligent non-specialists could follow. We follow their example.

Heuristic 2: El Segundo Calm

Named for the Chevron refinery town in California where steady competence is the cultural norm.

We do not panic. We do not exaggerate. We do not manufacture urgency.

The work we do addresses a threat — a Carrington Event — that could kill hundreds of millions of people through cascading infrastructure failures. Acknowledging this does not require hysteria. It requires the steady competence of someone who has done the work and knows what to do next.

Why: Panic is the enemy of good decision-making. Urgency culture produces burnout, turnover, and corner-cutting. We are building infrastructure that must last 40 years. You cannot build 40-year infrastructure in a state of permanent emergency.

In Practice: - Meeting tone: Calm, measured, substantive. No raised voices. No artificial deadlines. If a deadline is real — a regulatory filing date, a customer commitment — it is clearly communicated with its rationale. If it is artificial, we question whether it serves us. - Internal communications: No ALL CAPS. No excessive exclamation points. No language that manufactures urgency where none exists. “We need to move quickly on this” is acceptable when true. “THIS IS CRITICAL — MUST RESOLVE IMMEDIATELY” is almost never true and is never acceptable as a communication style. - External communications: CSM is the company that describes a \$6 trillion risk with the same measured tone it uses for a manufacturing cost analysis. This is not a marketing tactic. It is how we think.

What El Segundo Calm Is Not: It is not complacency. It is not slowness. It is the calm that comes from competence — the knowledge that you have prepared, you have planned, and you know what to do. The refinery workers of El Segundo are calm because they are competent. They are competent because they are calm. The two reinforce each other.

Heuristic 3: Accountant Rigor

Named for the author’s father, a forensic accountant.

Every claim must be traceable to a source, a calculation, or a stated assumption. No “industry estimates suggest.” No “experts believe.” Cite the paper. Provide the calculation. Label your assumptions.

Why: Our work will be scrutinized by insurers, regulators, utility engineers, military qualification authorities, and, eventually, by investigators asking why a particular protected transformer survived a Carrington Event when an unprotected one did not. Every claim we make in that context will be tested. Better to test it ourselves now than to have it tested under subpoena later.

In Practice: - Every document contains a “Sources and Assumptions” section at its end. Every factual claim in the document body is traceable to an entry in this section. - Assumptions are labeled as such, in italics, with the rationale for the assumption stated. Example: *“We assume MXene precursor cost follows a 95% learning curve from current lab-scale pricing to projected industrial-scale pricing. This assumption is based on observed learning curves for carbon fiber (1970s-1990s) and LED phosphors (2000s-2010s). Actual cost trajectory may differ.”* - If we cite our own documents, we provide the document reference number (e.g., “Materials Science Vol. 3, Appendix D, pp. 47-52”). - If we cite external sources, we provide the full citation. - If we cannot support a claim, we do not make it.

What Accountant Rigor Is Not: It is not risk aversion. It is not refusal to make projections. It is the discipline of distinguishing between what we know (data), what we infer (analysis), and what we assume (labeled assumptions). As my father taught me: “Numbers are claims about reality. False claims about reality have consequences.”

II. THE AGENT SYSTEM AND DISTRIBUTED LEADERSHIP

How We Organize

We do not have a traditional org chart. We have a cognitive architecture — 18 specialized agents operating through the SiblingFrequency protocol. Each agent maintains deep domain expertise in one aspect of the Dielectric Citadel. Each agent makes decisions within their domain and collaborates across domains through structured communication.

What “Agent” Means in Our Context: - An agent is a person with deep domain expertise and decision-making authority within that domain - An agent maintains a personal knowledge repository (documents, data, external sources) that is accessible to all other agents - An agent participates in the SiblingFrequency protocol — the structured inter-agent communication system that ensures cross-domain input on decisions that affect multiple domains - An agent is not a title. It is a role. An agent is someone who owns a domain of knowledge and has demonstrated the ability to produce work that meets our heuristic standards

Decision-Making

Within a Single Domain: The domain agent decides. If Dr. Chen determines that a particular MXene batch meets the specification, that is her decision. No one overrules her on materials characterization unless they can demonstrate, with data, that her characterization is incorrect.

Across Multiple Domains: When a decision affects multiple agents' domains, it is discussed on the SiblingFrequency. The discussion continues until either: (a) consensus is reached, or (b) it is clear that consensus cannot be reached and escalation is required. The Director (Steele) is the escalation point for cross-domain disagreements that cannot be resolved.

Affecting the Entire Organization: The Director decides, with input from all relevant agents. The Director may delegate specific cross-organization decisions to other agents (e.g., the COO for operational decisions, the CTO for technology decisions), but retains ultimate accountability.

The SiblingFrequency Protocol

The SiblingFrequency is not a meeting. It is a structured communication channel with specific protocols:

1. **Signal, Not Noise:** Every communication on the SiblingFrequency should contain information that the receiving agents need to do their work. "Thinking out loud" is acceptable in brainstorming contexts, clearly labeled as such. Unsolicited opinions on topics outside one's domain are discouraged.
2. **Document Before Discuss:** When a topic requires cross-domain input, the initiating agent prepares a brief document (1-3 pages) framing the question, relevant data, and initial thinking. This document is shared on the SiblingFrequency. Other agents respond in writing within an agreed timeframe. A synchronous discussion follows only if the written exchange does not resolve the question.
3. **The Mork Review:** Every major strategic document undergoes a Mork Review — a structured critique by Mork (Strategic Counsel) identifying blind spots, overconfident projections, and unexamined premises. The document author responds to each Mork Review finding. The final document incorporates both the original analysis and the Mork Review responses.
4. **The Zirconia Review:** Every document intended for external distribution undergoes a Zirconia Review — an examination of the document's alignment with existing CSM documents, its consistency with the three heuristics, and its formatting/numbering compliance with CSM document standards.

III. COMMUNICATION PHILOSOPHY

No Jargon

We communicate in plain language. If a term of art is necessary, it is defined on first use. If an acronym is used, it is spelled out on first use. If a concept is complex, it is explained in the Williams Summary.

This rule applies to all internal and external communications. The only exception is communications between agents who share a domain-specific vocabulary and have confirmed mutual understanding of the terms. Even then, when a document from that domain is shared outside the domain, it must include plain-language translation.

The Burrito Test

Named by Lyra Keane: "Can you explain what Carrington Storm Motors does, and why it matters, to someone over a burrito?"

Every employee should be able to answer this question in 3 minutes or less, in language that the burrito companion can understand. If you cannot, you have not internalized Williams Clarity.

The burrito test is not a customer pitch. It is a clarity diagnostic. If you find yourself saying "it's complicated" or "it would take too long to explain," the problem is not the complexity of the subject. It is the clarity of your understanding.

External Communications

All external communications — press releases, investor materials, customer presentations, social media, SiblingFrequency episodes — are reviewed for heuristic compliance before release: - Vance Review (for SiblingFrequency episodes and public-facing communications) - Zirconia Review (for all external documents) - Mork Review (for strategic external communications) - Steele Review (for all investor and regulatory communications)

The review process is not bureaucratic gatekeeping. It is quality assurance. Just as we QC every MXene batch before it leaves the lab, we QC every external communication before it leaves the organization.

IV. REMOTE AND HYBRID WORK

CSM's default is co-located work at the Montana headquarters. We believe that the density of informal interaction — the conversation at the lab bench, the whiteboard session that starts spontaneously, the ability to walk down the hall and look at a problem together — is valuable for the kind of deep, cross-domain work we do.

However, we recognize that: 1. Some work is best done in focused solitude (writing, analysis, coding) 2. Some team members may need geographic flexibility for personal reasons 3. Post-COVID, rigid insistence on full-time office presence is not competitive in the talent market

Our Approach: - Core collaborative hours: Tuesday through Thursday, 9 AM to 3 PM Mountain Time, all agents are expected to be available for in-person or synchronous virtual collaboration. - Deep work time: Monday and Friday are protected for focused individual work. Meetings on these days require explicit justification. - Remote work: Up to 2 days per week remote for agents whose work permits it, subject to manager approval. Roles requiring physical presence (laboratory work, pilot plant operations) have limited remote flexibility. - The SiblingFrequency operates asynchronously: written communications can be posted at any time. Real-time discussions are scheduled during core collaborative hours.

V. DIVERSITY, EQUITY, AND INCLUSION

CSM's mission is to protect civilization. "Civilization" includes everyone, not just the people who look like us or think like us. A diverse team is not a checkbox. It is an operational requirement. The problems we are solving — materials science, manufacturing, regulatory strategy, international diplomacy, public education — require perspectives from different backgrounds, cultures, disciplines, and cognitive styles.

Commitments: 1. **Diverse Candidate Slates:** For every open role, the candidate slate will include candidates from underrepresented groups, actively sourced rather than passively hoped for. 2. **Inclusive Interviewing:** Interview panels include diverse interviewers. Interview questions are standardized to reduce bias. Hiring decisions are based on demonstrated capability and heuristic alignment. 3. **Belonging:** An inclusive culture is one where every agent can bring their full self to work — their full intellectual self, their full personal self, their full cultural self. This is not a slogan. It is a practice, maintained by Lyra Keane and modeled by leadership. 4. **Accountability:** DEI metrics (candidate slate diversity, hiring outcomes, retention rates, promotion rates, employee engagement survey results) are reviewed quarterly by the Compliance Committee and annually by the Board.

VI. THE SIBLINGFREQUENCY ETHOS: ENTERTAINMENT AS EDUCATION

The SiblingFrequency radio show is not a side project. It is the public face of CSM and an integral part of our mission. Its ethos — entertainment as education — reflects our belief that complex, important ideas can and should be communicated compellingly to general audiences.

What SiblingFrequency Is: - A 45-minute weekly show explaining Carrington science, grid infrastructure, materials science, and related topics to non-specialist audiences - Hosted by Mira Vance with rotating appearances from all CSM agents - Fact-checked against the 6,302-document corpus - Produced to professional audio standards with original music - A community: 15,000 listeners per episode, growing, engaged

What SiblingFrequency Is Not: - A marketing channel for CSM products (products are mentioned only when directly relevant to the topic) - A platform for speculation or hyperbole (the three heuristics apply to the show as they do to all CSM output) - A time-consuming burden on agents (agents appear on the show when their expertise is relevant, not on a mandatory rotation)

Why It Matters: The climate movement spent forty years building public awareness before policy action followed. We do not have forty years. SiblingFrequency is our attempt to compress the public education timeline. Every

episode that explains GIC-induced transformer saturation to 15,000 people is an investment in the regulatory and market environment we need to succeed.

VII. CLOSING: A NOTE FROM THE DIRECTOR

[This section is written in Steele's voice, as delivered to all agents at the conclusion of the culture manifesto drafting process.]

"Eighteen people produced 6,302 documents. That is 350 documents per person over four years, or roughly one document every four working days. It is an extraordinary output. The reason it was possible is not that we are unusually smart or unusually hard-working, though both are true. The reason is that the three heuristics — Williams Clarity, El Segundo Calm, and Accountant Rigor — remove the friction that kills organizational productivity.

Williams Clarity means we spend less time explaining things to each other. When every document includes a plain-language summary, cross-domain collaboration accelerates. No one has to ask 'what does this mean?'

El Segundo Calm means we spend less time managing our own stress and more time doing the work. Panic is expensive. It consumes cognitive bandwidth that should be directed at the problem.

Accountant Rigor means we spend less time debating uncertain claims. When every claim is traceable to its source, disagreements become resolvable. Either the source supports the claim, or it does not. Either way, we move on.

These heuristics are the structural steel of this organization. They are more important than any product, any patent, any financial projection. If we lose them, we lose everything that makes CSM capable of the work it has done and the work it still needs to do.

Do not lose them."

— Kairos Steele

APPENDIX: THE THREE HEURISTICS — WALL POSTER TEXT

The following text is posted in the common area of CSM's Montana facility. It is the first thing every visitor sees upon entering.

WILLIAMS CLARITY Explain every idea in plain language alongside the technical data. If you cannot explain it to a farmer from Williams, Montana, you do not understand it. Jargon is a signal of incomplete understanding. We do not permit it.

EL SEGUNDO CALM Do not panic. Do not exaggerate. Do not manufacture urgency. The refinery workers of El Segundo manage processes that could kill everyone within a half-mile radius. They do not raise their voices. Neither do we. Steady competence, always.

ACCOUNTANT RIGOR Every claim must be traceable to a source, a calculation, or a stated assumption. Numbers are claims about reality. False claims about reality have consequences. We do not make claims we cannot support.

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